

Welcome Workbook

Raising Arizona Preschool



By Michele Chavez

Copyright © 2023 by AASC, Developmental Services , LLC. dba Lily Luna Press

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, or transmitted in any form or by any means, including photocopying, recording, or other electronic or mechanical methods, without the prior written permission of the publisher



Michele is a content creator, writer, an early education professional and advocate. She has a degree with cognates in both early childhood education /child developmental behavioral health with a certificate in Leadership, she works daily in the early childhood education field.

Michele serves as the Program Coordinator for Raising Arizona Preschool, she can be reached at
623-777-0113

michele@raisingarizonapreschool.com

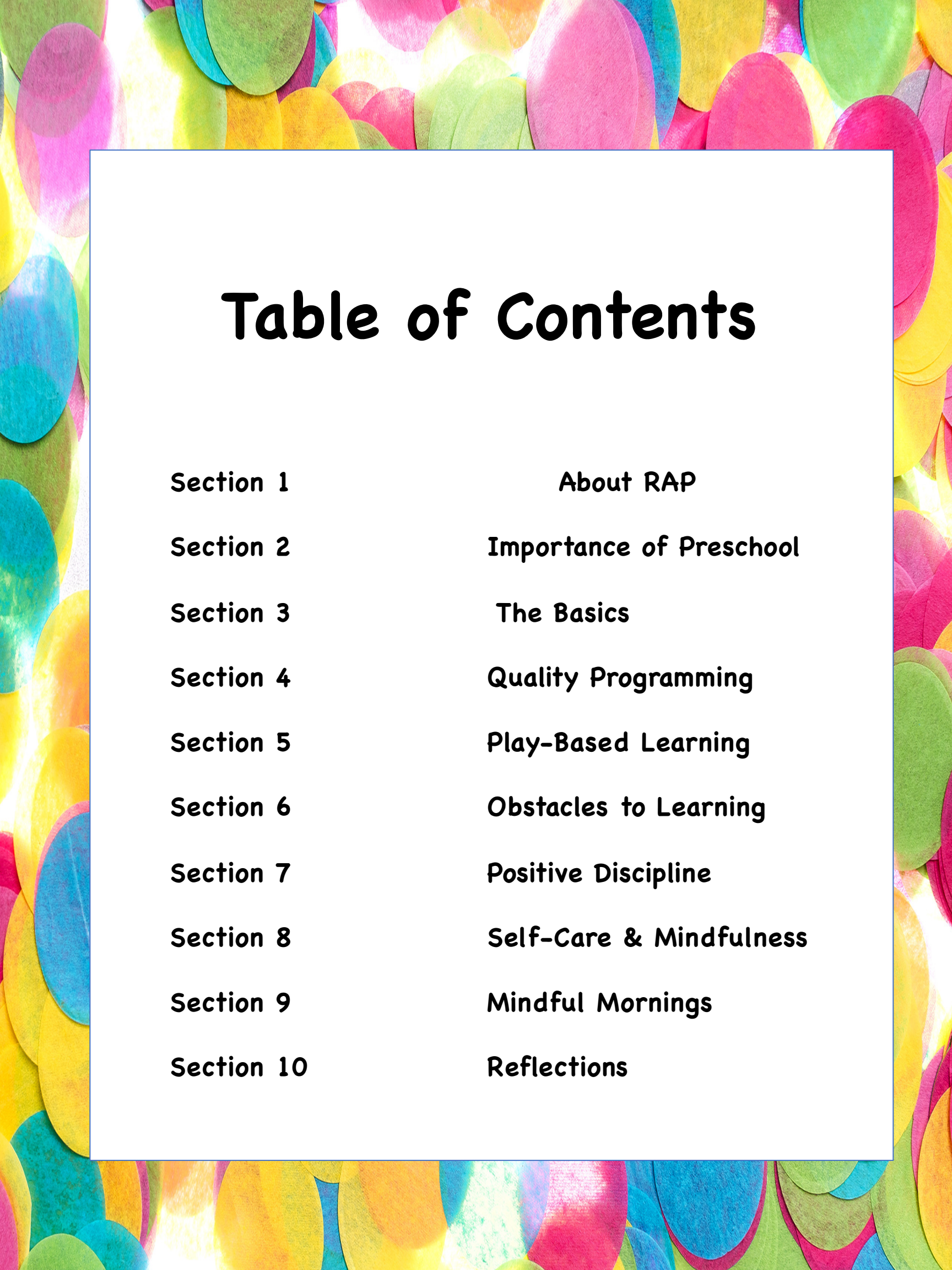


Table of Contents

Section 1	About RAP
Section 2	Importance of Preschool
Section 3	The Basics
Section 4	Quality Programming
Section 5	Play-Based Learning
Section 6	Obstacles to Learning
Section 7	Positive Discipline
Section 8	Self-Care & Mindfulness
Section 9	Mindful Mornings
Section 10	Reflections



Welcome

Welcome the RAP Team! We are happy to have you on our Team. This Orientation workbook will familiarize you with RAP and your role as part of the RAP Team.

As you work through this book , take time to understand and answer all questions at the end of each section. You will be turning your completed Book in for 10 hours of training.

As you work on each section, please reach out to the Directors and other teachers you work, ask questions and share your feedback.

This book has been designed for you to keep and use as a resource when needed.

Thank you for taking the time to invest in yourself and the children we serve at RAP.

**Raising
Arizona
Preschool**

Terms Needed

These terms will be defined more thoroughly throughout this workbook.

Mindfulness-

Mindfulness is a type of meditation in which you focus on being intensely aware of what you're sensing and feeling in the moment, without interpretation or judgment. Practicing mindfulness involves breathing methods, guided imagery, and other practices to relax the body and mind and help reduce stress.

Mindful Mornings-

Raising Arizona Preschool , RAP, practice of teaching, guiding, and exploring mindfulness with young children.

Play-Based Learning-

A system that uses play as a context for learning. As children play, they engage their imagination, take risks, and learn problem-solving to support their development. Play-based learning is child-initiated and teacher supported

Teacher Protocols-

RAP's official procedure or system of rules governing how teachers conduct themselves.

Section 1

RAP Philosophy

Raising Arizona Preschool puts children as a priority. We understand that there are hundreds of different preschools and childcare centers in the Valley, but we want you to understand how truly unique we are!

By providing children with a creative, stimulating environment, we will encourage children's imagination while maintaining a high level of care and support.

We also have implemented Mindfulness for staff and children.

You are now part of this dynamic Team!



CORE VALUES

Priorities

At Raising Arizona, we believe that there is no such thing as a “bad” child. Our preschools have a unique approach to childcare focusing more on praising good behavior rather than punishing bad.

NARRATIVE

We help develop a child's Narrative!

Chapter 1 in a child's life in many ways defines who they become, we help parents write an amazing first chapter, filled with gratitude and self confidence.

MINDFULNESS

We use daily fun mindfulness techniques. We foster an atmosphere of mindfulness. This teaches children to self-regulate and focus. These mindfulness activities will help children in their future school success.

LOVE

We understand that children don't care what you know until they know that you care about them, so we do everything we can to help children feel loved in our classrooms.

As part of the RAP Team, it is the expectation that you will strive and seek to keep the Core Values of RAP in all you do. These four core values need to drive your interactions with children, families, co-workers and your leadership team.

If you maintain the RAP Core Values everything you do in your day will take on added meaning. Every day, each moment is the opportunity to change lives.



THE 5 "BEEES" OF

Raising Arizona Preschool



WE WILL BEE...

BEE LOVING

WE WILL LOVE YOU CHILD LIKE OUR OWN

BEE PREPARED

WE WILL PLAN OUT OUR DAY, EVERY HOUR WE WILL BE PREPARED

BEE LOYAL

WE WILL BE LOYAL TO OUR SCHOOL AND FAMILIES HERE

BEE HAPPY

WE WILL CHOOSE TO BE HAPPY EVERY DAY

BEE CONSISTENT

WE WILL ALWAYS BE CONSISTENT, NO MATTER WHAT
IS GOING ON IN OUR PERSONAL LIVES





First Weeks with RAP

Being new to the classroom or school can be overwhelming at times.

It happens to everyone; you are not alone. We encourage you to lean on your Leadership team and co-teachers for support.

Chances are whatever it is you feel you are struggling with; someone else has also been in the same place.

In fact, you **should be asking for help. We encourage and expect for new staff to ask for help from other teachers and Leadership Staff.**

If you are not asking for help in some way, about something, then perhaps you should consider reaching out.

Remember, your Leadership Team encourages and expects questions, lots of them!

Everyone on the RAP Team is here to assist you be successful in the classroom.

Your Handbook and Protocols

You have been given and should have read your Employee Handbook prior to accepting a position with RAP.

If you have any question about what is in your handbook, please ask your Director.

Please Review your Protocols with your Director Team.

On the following pages you will learn about RAP Protocols (the official procedure or system of rules governing expectations of behavior while here at RAP) and what actions can be taken when protocols are continually ignored.

Teacher & Staff PROTOCOLS



We are not
calling you out,
we are calling
you up!

In an effort to build a culture of excellence and a team of the best teachers in Arizona, we are calling you up. IF you want to be part of our Raising Arizona team, these are the new rules that will be followed with ZERO EXCEPTIONS. We will hold you accountable for these basic rules.

Professionalism

- ☐ Must wear a Polo with a Logo each day (unless it's a spirit day)
- ☐ No personal cell phone use in the classroom
- ☐ Bring a great attitude, smile, greet EVERYONE who walks into your classroom with a kind tone of voice. Sound HAPPY to be here!

Communication

- ☐ All communication with parents and coworkers is positive based!
- ☐ ZERO tolerance policy for gossip!
- ☐ Communicate with coworkers anything they need to know before leaving.
- ☐ Always express and concerns with Directors.

Clean Room

- ☐ Clutter free
- ☐ Smells Good
- ☐ Organized & Clean
- ☐ Everything labeled

Safety

- ☐ Name to Face counts - Hourly & when moving classrooms
- ☐ Always inspect class & playground for hazards. Voice concerns.
- ☐ KNOW YOUR COUNT
- ☐ Follow all state licensing policies

Attendance

- ☐ Be on time for your shift & breaks - Be Mindful of the day
- ☐ ALL ABSENCES must be approved as far before your shift as possible.
- ☐ After 3 days of Callouts - Dr. note required
- ☐ You must call EACH day to call out. As well as check in EACH day - end of day

Nap Time

Nap time is ACTIVE time!

- ☐ Work on your lesson plans, clean, sort etc..
- ☐ Update Procure App
- ☐ No laying down for any reason
- ☐ Pat children no longer than 10-15 min.
- ☐ Ensure the room is NOT dark, just dim

Education/Training

- ☐ Minimum of 24 hours of training in the registry per year (anniversary date)
- ☐ Attend all staff meetings & events
- ☐ Understand & IMPLEMENT Quality First ECRS/ITERS, CLASS & Portfolios
- ☐ Keep up on certifications - CPR/1st Aid, Food handlers, Fingerprint Card

Mindfulness

- ☐ Staff will clock in then do a 10-15 minute Mindful exercise each day.
- ☐ Staff will promote Mindful Mornings with children each day
- ☐ Try to better yourself and improve yourself each and every day.

Time Management

- ☐ Ensure you are cleaning as you go, so when the children combine, you just have to take out your trash to the dumpster.
- ☐ Leave yourself time to prep activities, the classroom will run smoothly.
- ☐ Ask for supplies well in advance so Directors can get these to you in a timely fashion.

Most important - We want you to BE HAPPY & love where you work and what you do!

Leave all the drama at the door and let this be your safe place.
After one year, you will receive paid holidays when we are closed.

RAISING ARIZONA PRESCHOOL

Disciplinary Action

Employee Name: _____ Position: _____

Date(s) of Violation: _____

At Raising Arizona Preschool, we will uphold every employee to the same standards. If any employee repeats the same offense twice, termination is the next step. There are ways to redeem yourself to expunge the disciplinary action plan.

Type of offense:

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Professionalism | ☐ Communication | ☐ Clean Room |
| ☐ Safety | ☐ Attendance | ☐ Nap Time |
| ☐ Education/Training | ☐ Mindfulness | ☐ Time Management |

Offense Number: ☐ One ☐ Two ☐ Termination: as of _____
Written Warning Suspension/Probation

Supporting Evidence (if any): _____

Expected Improvement Plan: _____

- ☐ I understand this notice of disciplinary action and have read it in its entirety.
(Employee will sign this page and any other pages that show supporting documents)
- ☐ Employee refused to sign this document and all supporting documents

Employee Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Director Signature: _____ Date: _____



Section 1 Reflections

What are 3 things you learned from this section?

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Share your thoughts on the RAP Core Values?

Define what a Protocol is? Name 2 Teacher Protocols you will be expected to adhere to while at RAP.

Section 2

The Importance of Preschool

What does Preschool provide?

Preschool provides an environment for children to explore, gain a sense of self, play with peers and build self-confidence.

Children learn they can accomplish tasks and make decisions without the help of their family. Behavior management is a major part of preschool learning.

Preschool is a great option for many families.

Preschool advantages include a consistent structure and routine, with a focus on early education (which can inspire a love of learning).

Most programs also teach children a variety of cognitive, social, emotional, and language skills.

When children are young, they are learning sponges. Every new experience, every word they learn, every behavior they adopt, is and lends to a child's future success.

You can never have a greater impression on a person than when they are in their early childhood years.

Early childhood education is about creating a love of learn, which will eventually form the basis of a lifelong journey into building knowledge.



Basic Skills Preschool Gives to Children

- **Socialization**
- **Concept of Cooperation**
- **Enthusiasm for Lifelong Learning**
- **Respect**
- **Teamwork**
- **Resilience**
- **Concentration**
- **Patience**
- **Confidence and Self-Esteem**
- **Exposure to Diversity**



Socialization

Socialization with people other than the child's family in a safe environment is an essential.

Caregivers intuitively understand that it's important to introduce children to other children and support their transition into their own friendship groups.

The earlier we do this, the better, as it helps children overcome shyness and gain self-confidence. If we leave this too long, we hinder their social development.

Enthusiasm for Lifelong Learning

Lessons should be given in a fun and exciting way that will encourage children to be effective learners.

We need to inspire a thirst for learning with eagerness and enthusiasm.

Love of education- for reading, learning, and discovery takes root in preschool

Concept of Cooperation

Learning how to share, cooperate, take turns and persevere within a safe learning environment, guided by professionals who have the children's best interests at heart.

This is especially important for the child, who may not be used to sharing with siblings at home - while it can be a difficult lesson, it's so crucial to learn it early.

Respect

Teaching the value of respect for others is not limited to people and belongings, but can also mean respect for their environment, both immediate and global.

There is no better place to learn this virtue than in a hectic preschool environment, where everything is shared, and civility and manners are both taught and learned organically.



Teamwork

Demonstrating and instilling the importance of teamwork can teach respect for the opinions of others, listening, cooperation and equality.

Many preschool activities are centered around teamwork for this very reason; a person who learns how to work in a team at an early age will ultimately be more socially attuned and more employable!

Resilience- the capacity to withstand or to recover quickly from difficulties; toughness.

Resilience

It's important that early childhood educators and parents work together to develop resilience in children as early as possible.

By creating a consistent, secure and fair social environment, with clear expectations and predictable consequences, children can develop skills in managing themselves and their emotions.

It's a teacher's job to provide a challenging environment where children can learn through firsthand experiences. They may experience bumps, bruises or losing a game from time-to-time, but this is the foundation for building coping strategies for greater challenges in life.

Concentration

During preschool years, children explore at every opportunity to discover new experiences, new friends and new environments. Their minds are so lively and imaginative.

As early childhood educators we need to balance this zest with the ability to listen, follow directions, attend to tasks and participate in group activities to develop the critical life skill of concentration.

Patience:

Every day as adults, we encounter situations where our patience is tested. Children need opportunities to be involved in an abundance of social experiences, where they can explore and practice the social skill of patience.

By teaching through examples, role modeling and social experiences, children are able to develop their patience and learn to wait for their turn. Examples from the preschool setting include sharing a teacher's attention, a toy, the playground or waiting in line for a game.

Confidence and Self-Esteem

This is critical. A strong sense of wellbeing provides children with confidence, optimism and self-esteem which will encourage children to explore their talents, skills and interests.

Positive interactions with other children and teachers will promote a positive, healthy and secure view of themselves that will allow them to approach situations and problems confidently throughout their lives.



Exposure to Diversity

Valuing difference and diversity are crucial to a child's early development.

Early childhood education serves to guide children to appreciate and accept differences and become well-rounded contributors to society.

It is important that children understand that everyone is unique and special in their own way with their own culture, beliefs and ethnicity.



**Preschool is so much more
than playing.**

**While the basic educational
benefits of preschool (such as
literacy and numeracy) are
tangible, the advances
children achieve towards
becoming well-rounded
individuals are truly
invaluable.**





Section 2 Reflections

Choose two reason why preschool is important and write a short paragraph below explaining why these two stood out to you.

Name and define in your own words a skills children gain in preschool.

Section 3

The Basics

15

Raising Arizona Preschool (RAP) is governed by several different agencies.

In addition to Arizona Childcare Licensing RAP is also accountable to the following governing bodies:

- Department of Health and Immunizations
- CACFP= Child and Adult Care Food Program
- Maricopa Department of Health Services
- Quality First and First Things First

RAP provides high quality early educational and childcare services and is subject to the rules and regulations of the Arizona Department of Health.

Children must always be supervised . There is no exception. If you need to leave your classroom at anytime, please alert the Office and accommodations will be made. At no time should your class be left alone.

Ratios and Safety Standards, we follow are determined by the State of Arizona.

State Ratios:

One year old 1:6

Two-year-old 1:8

Three-year-old 1:13

Four-year-old 1:15

School Aged 1:20



An important part of RAP that you should be aware of is the the Quality First program.



RAP has a 3 & 4-Star ratings, and we strive to provide high quality care. This means your classroom needs to be equipped with Quality First (QF) standards. From room arrangement to Lesson Plans you will be following QF recommended standards. Do not worry, you will learn more about QF as you progress here at RAP.

You will have a QF Coach who will be helping you along the way.

RAP also part of the Federal Food Program. We adhere to strict regulations regarding food and nutrition. Important things to remember:

- Wear gloves when serving
- Mark children served on food roster while they are eating.
- Be sure you are sitting with children and eating with them



PLAYGROUND SAFETY

SUPERVISE and INTERACT

Teachers always need to supervise and have children visually within site .

Play with the children do not simply watch them. Encourage active involvement.

Playground Safety Rules for Kids

- Use both hands when climbing.
- Avoid climbing on wet equipment. ...
- Never climb up the front of slides. ...
- Remove broken toys
- Avoid pushing or shoving.



HANDWASHING

Handwashing is very important in the preschool setting. It helps to reduce illness for children and staff.

Children need to lather hands for minimum of 20 seconds to adhere to guidelines.

Have children sing a simple song like ABC's or make up a song about soapy bubbles while they scrub hands. This takes about 20 seconds to sing.

Children need to wash hands before and after meals, after restroom, and after coming in from outside.

Remember it starts with you! Set a good example and wash your hands before and after meals, diapers, and being outside.





Section 3 Reflections

Write a paragraph about outdoor safety and what is the single most important thing when outdoors.

In your own words, how would you ensure children are scrubbing with bubbles for 20 seconds?

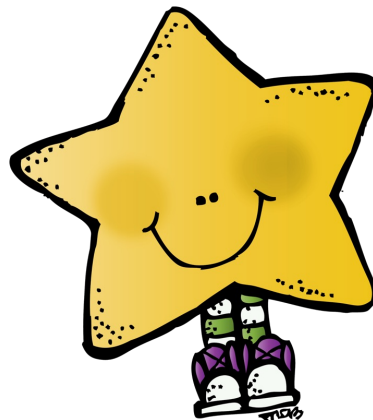
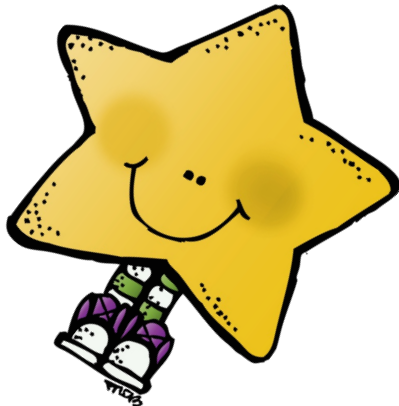
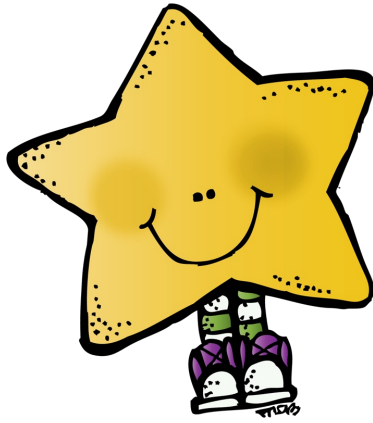
What are the three important things to remember when serving food to the children?

Section 4

Quality Programming

Quality early learning settings build on basic health and safety to include:

- Teachers and caregivers who know how to work with infants, toddlers and preschoolers
- Positive, nurturing relationships that give young kids the individual attention they need
- Learning environments that encourage creativity and imaginative play
- Hands-on activities that stimulate and encourage positive brain connections in children
- Caregivers who provide regular feedback to parents on the development of their child



About Quality First

Quality First is Arizona's quality improvement and rating system for early learning programs.

Created and administered by First Things First, Quality First partners with more than 1,000 licensed and regulated childcare and preschool providers across the state to improve the quality of their early learning programs for children from birth to age 5 and help more Arizona kids arrive at kindergarten ready to succeed.

How states measure quality in early childhood

As you progress in role as a teacher you will become more familiar with these tools listed below.

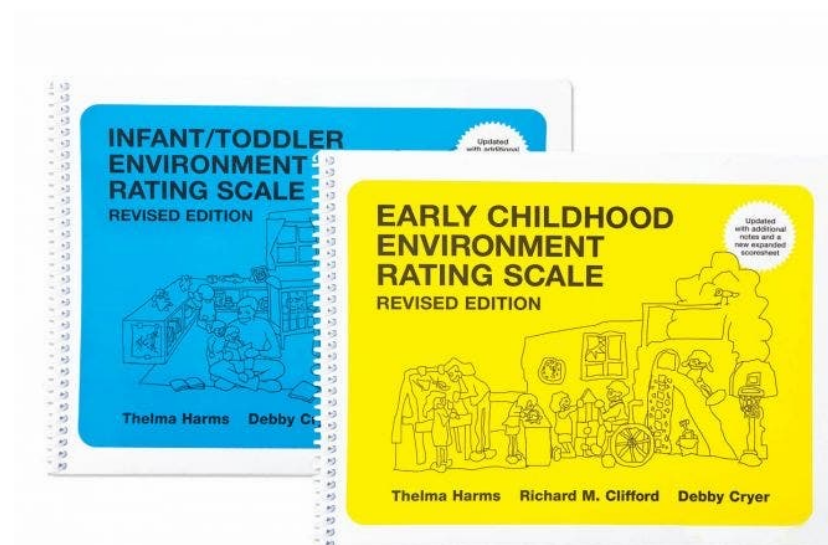
QRIS: All states either have a quality rating and improvement system, or QRIS

CLASS: The Classroom Assessment Scoring System, or CLASS, is an observation tool that assesses the interactions between teachers and children that affect learning and development

Environment rating scales:

The Early Childhood Environment Rating Scale, or **ECERS** for children ages 3–5

The Infant/Toddler Environment Rating Scale, or **ITERS**,



Quality Preschool is;

- Play-Based Hands-on Learning
- Encourages Language skills
- Open Free Choice Learning Centers
- Observation and Assessment

At RAP we use a play-based curriculum that is inspired by the project approach.

You will be learning more about play-based further in this book.

In addition, RAP supports and encourages a Reggio Emilia Inspired play -based approach to learning.

We believe children learn best through doing and provide ample time during the day for children explore the environment as well as planned activities.

The classroom is made up area called “Centers”. Active child directed play-based learning is the focus of these Centers.



8 Main Learning Centers

The Art **Center**.

The Block **Center**.

The Book **Center**.

The Dramatic Play **Center**.

The Manipulatives/Table

Toys **Center**.

The Music **Center**.

The Sand and Water **Center**.

The Science and Nature **Center**.

Centers may also be

Writing Center

Seasonal Centers

STEM or STEAM

Centers



Quality Preschool is-

- Ample Free Choice Center Time
- Structures Planned Small Group Activities
- Play-Based Hands-on Learning
- Open Ended Activities

A High-Quality Preschool has;

- Time for Teacher led large group learning and discussions as well as small group instruction and learning.
- Time for child led free play in learning centers



Quality Preschool is NOT-

- Flash Cards
- Worksheets
- Overly Structured Seat Work
- Activities that have a Right or Wrong Outcome

Assessment for Quality

Another key component of high-quality programs is observation and assessment cycle.

You will be Observed and Assessed when you are ready, semi-annually.

Your progress and financial incentives are based on your assessment scores.

You will learn more Quality First Assessments as you progress in your first 3-6 months with RAP.



Section 4 Reflections

In your own words create a statement about what quality preschool is;

In order to earn bonuses what must happen?
(tip it happens semi-annually)

What are 3 things a that should not be done in a high-quality preschool?

Section 5

Play-Based Learning

What is play based learning?

The Early Years **Learning** Framework defines **play-based learning** as 'a context for **learning** through which children organize and make sense of their social worlds, as they engage actively with people, objects and representations'. Children may engage in **play** on their own and explore different materials



Why is play based learning important?

Play based learning appeals to children's natural curiosity and desire to engage in experiences **based** on their interests, strengths and developing skills as they make sense of their world around them. Opportunities for large blocks of uninterrupted and unhurried time rather than small amounts of time to explore

Definition of play:

“Engage in activity for enjoyment and recreation rather than a serious or practical purpose.”

Play means doing something for fun, rather than for practical reasons. The beauty of this definition is that there's no one way to play.

Play doesn't mean just building with blocks or playing with cars. Play is versatile and can be different things to different people. For some people, it's climbing rocks. For others, writing. For some, it's reading a good book.



There are different play stages in early childhood.

There 6 basic Stages of play in young children.

Unoccupied play
Independent or solitary play
Onlooker play
Parallel play
Associative play
Cooperative play

Unoccupied play

Unoccupied play begins early infancy.

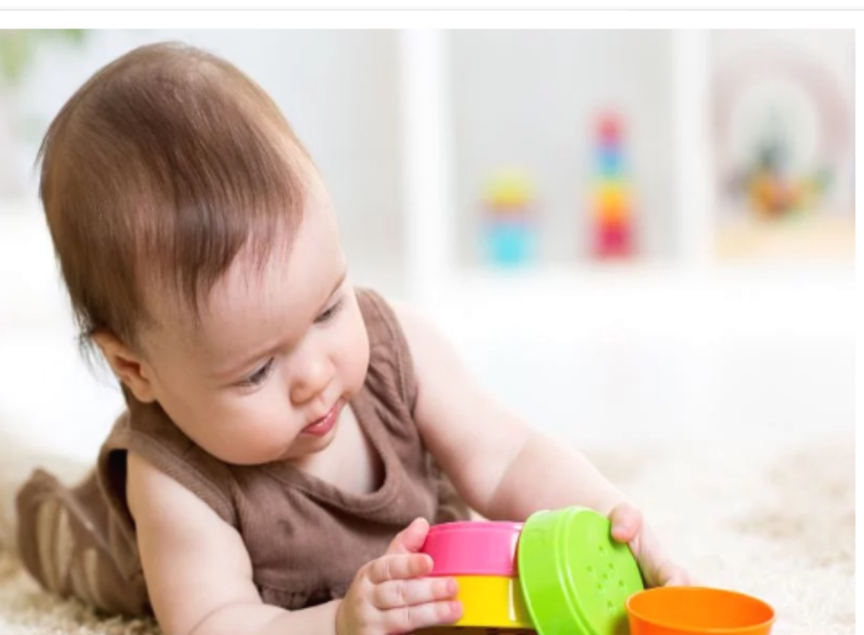
Baby or toddler creatively moves their body with no purpose other than it feels good and interesting.

UNOCCUPIED PLAY 0-3 Months

Child is completely free to think, move, and imagine. The entire world is new, so when you're thinking about playtime, don't worry about organizing anything.

Put baby on a soft floor and let him kick around, handing him a book or a rattle, and letting him do his thing.

Choose something with lots of textures and color, and avoid bright lights or surprising noises, as they may startle a baby.



Independent or solitary play

This is when your child plays alone, with little to no reference to what other kids or adults are doing.

This is an incredibly important stage. As many adults know, you can't bond properly to new people if you aren't comfortable by yourself.

Encouraging play early will make life easier, and the ability to be content with their own discovery will serve them well throughout life.

If they get this type of play through finding sticks on a walk, or reading a book quietly, that's totally up to them.

Independent or solitary play

3 months-2 years



Onlooker play

When a child observes the play of other children, while not actually playing themselves.

The ability to play with other kids is crucial to getting along in school and beyond. This is a baby's first stop in learning how.

Children will watch other children and adults play. Because, of this, Teachers must take an active role in play with the child at this stage in development.

This stage takes place after the prior two stages. Individual children will vary; however, this stage is typically developed by age 2.



Onlooker Play/Stage
3 months-2 years

Parallel play

Though they may use the same toys, children play *besides*, rather than *with*, other children.

Remember, learning to play is *learning how to relate to others*. In that sense, parallel play is that final stage before the child connects with another.

Toys that can be shared easily are ideal, as this period is often fraught with toddler breakdowns of “MINE!”

This is how the child prepares to move onto the next stage.

Parallel Play Stage 2+ years



Associative play

Here, children play with other children, but the kids do not organize their play toward a common goal.

Around age 3, a preschooler will experience a longer attention span, and will really enjoy the social aspect of other children.

While purposeful play is still a rarity, taking turns is a totally achievable goal.

Now is a great time to introduce more independent art supplies. Around age 3, children typically become more capable of handling smaller manipulatives, art supplies, and smaller builder materials, such as Legos.

Associative Play Stage 3-4 years



Cooperative play

At this stage of play you can see the beginning of teamwork. Children play with others for a common purpose.

In terms of play goals, this is the final developmental stage, because it's the same basic principle whether you're doing a school project, putting on a play, or playing a sport.

A child you can engage in cooperative play can handle a classroom. Interacting, socializing, and communicating sets the stage for social success throughout life.

It's an incredibly liberating and exciting step for individual children.

Cooperative Play Stage
4+ years



Review the types of play or stages of play again.

There 6 basic Stages of play in young children.

Unoccupied play
Independent or solitary play
Onlooker play
Parallel play
Associative play
Cooperative play

As a teacher at Raising Arizona Preschool, the expectation is that your classroom will provide learning through a fun, engaging, play –based curriculum .

That will look different according the age group you are working with. However, we all want what is best for children. If we provide plenty of time for learning through play, we can encourage brain development.

The human brain develops rapidly in the first years of life. Early childhood education is about those years.



Section 5 Reflections

Thinking about the age group you primarily work with , what stage or stages of play would aspect to see happening in the classroom?

Observe your classroom and make notes on the types/stages of play you observe;

Section 6

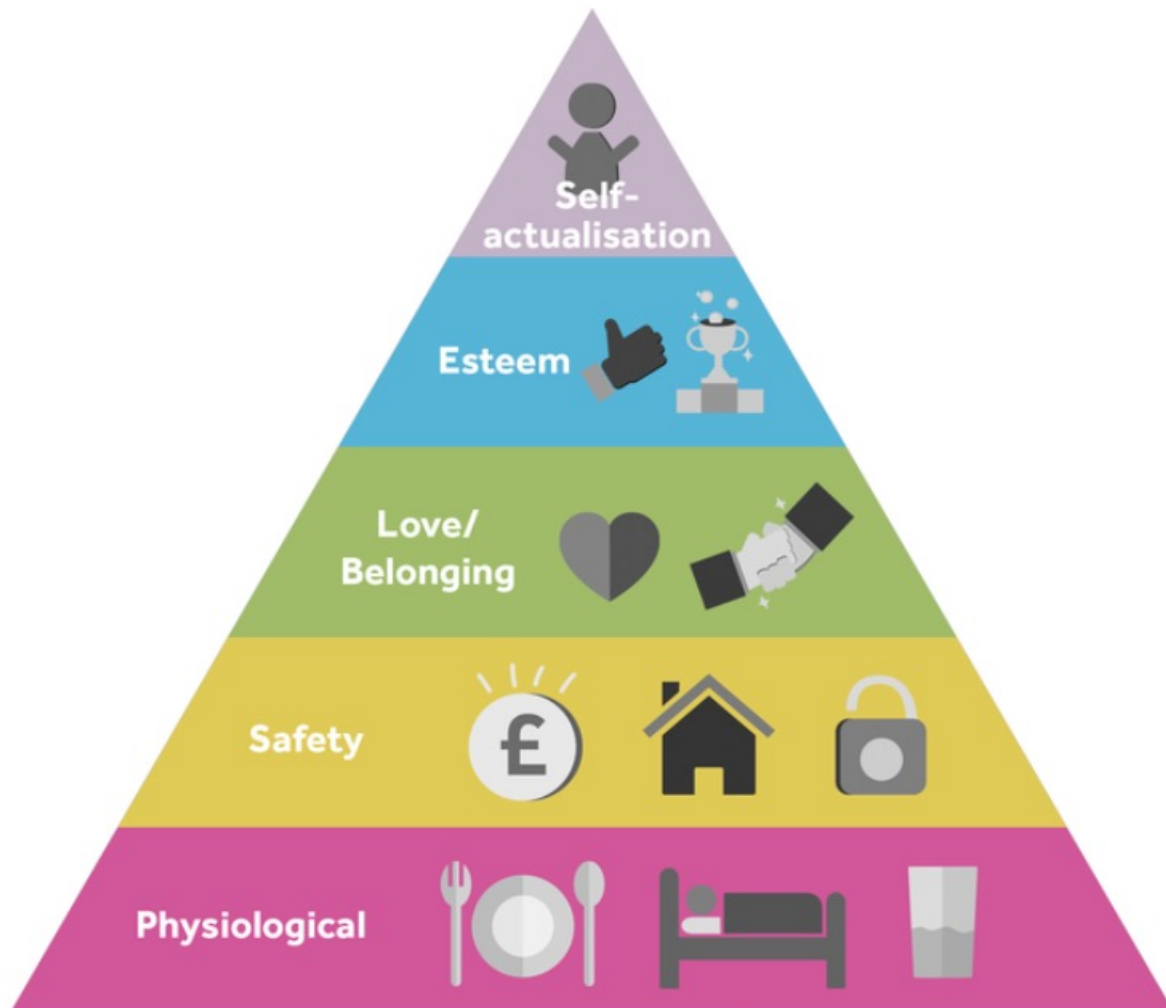
Obstacles to Learning

Maslow's Pyramid of needs is important to have a basic concept of as a teacher.

Children in your class who are not having the lower basic needs met will not be able to focus and learn.

Although, we can not always provide the basics when they are not at school, we can strive to provide them when are with us.

A child who is not fed , has no time to rest, and does not have basic safety needs met, will be a child who has a difficult time learning in the classroom.



Proper Nutrition

RAP provides FDA approved healthy and safe meals.

Encourage children in your classroom to eat , but NEVER force them.



Proper rest , sleep, and relaxation

Growing children need proper rest, sleep, or relaxation time. Proper rest is critical for early development.

Lack of sleep interferes with learning.



Safe Learning Environment



Children have a need for safety. This is both physical and emotional safety.

Your classroom should be safe and child proof. Materials need to be safe for young children and kids should have a sense of safety.

This is also where classroom management comes in. Rules, procedures, consequences, and motivations are part of a sense of safety.

Children need to feel a sense of loving and belonging in the classroom. Your classroom is a community. Everyone should feel love and belonging in the group.

Take time to build relationships with each child. In the long run, a child who has a warm relationship with the teacher is a child who can trust, learn, and feel accepted. A sense of love and belonging will reduce negative behaviors.

Love and Belonging

Children who feel loved and part of the classroom community have easier time learning new skills.



Self-Esteem

Confidence is crucial for children to challenge themselves and progress in the learning environment.

Self-esteem is built by providing opportunities for success.

Plan activities that a child can succeed in to built a sense of confidence.

Self-Actualization

"the full realization of one's potential"

Self-Actualization is when child's basic needs are met, and they have sense of self-esteem and confidence they can begin to learn new skills with ease.

At this stage children are eager and ready to try new things. They are confident that they are safe and ready to branch out a take risks in learning.

Each individual child has a different potential.

By providing the basic needs children must have to begin learning, we increase their ability to self-actualize.

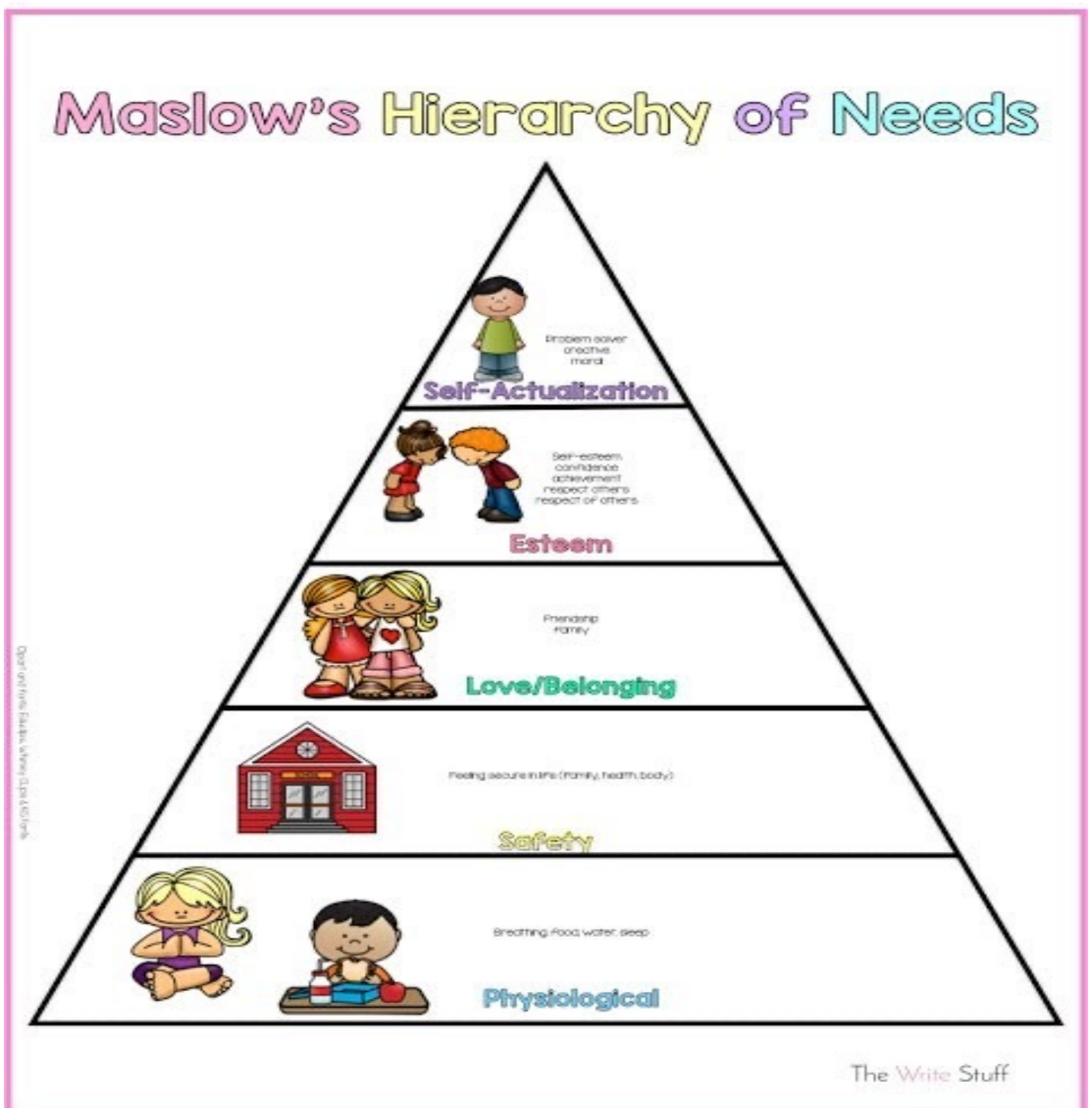


What does it all mean for the early education classroom?

For the teacher at RAP, it means you create a classroom that has the qualities that encourage reaching for self-actualization.

Set-up a classroom that meets basic needs and encourages complex needs to be met, By doing this you are providing an optimal learning environment.

When I have proper nutrition and rest , and I feel loved I can move onto more complex needs such as confidence, self-control, and reach my full potential!



Section 6 Reflections

Choose one obstacle to learning from this section and write a paragraph about your thoughts about specific obstacle and how to help combat it.

Observe your classroom and identify one obstacle to learning you are aware for any children in your care. How can you. Help to offset this obstacle when the child is at school?

Section 7

Positive Guidance

Reframing Discipline

Recent research tells us that children are hardwired from birth to connect with others, and that children who feel a sense of connection to their community, family, and school are less likely to misbehave.

To be successful, contributing members of their community, children must learn necessary social and life skills.



Positive Discipline is based on the understanding that discipline must be taught, and that discipline teaches.

Redirecting Behaviors

Learn ways to redirect a child's challenging behavior before it escalates.

- Verbally
- Physical
- Cue
- Redirecting Attention

Positive Discipline teaches important social and life skills in a manner that is deeply respectful and encouraging for both children and adults.

FIVE CRITERIA FOR POSITIVE DISCIPLINE

1. Is **Kind and Firm** at the same time.
(Respectful and encouraging)
2. Helps children feel a sense of **Belonging and Significance**.
(Connection)
3. Is **Effective Long-Term**.
(Punishment works short term but has negative long-term results.)
4. Teaches valuable **Social and Life Skills** for good character.
(Respect, concern for others, problem-solving, accountability, contribution, cooperation)
5. Invites children to discover how **Capable** they are and to use their personal power in constructive ways.

Positive Guidance

It is best to have a plan to address off-task behavior and misbehavior when it occurs.

However, often teachers may make decisions in the heat of the moment when responding to misbehavior, and these responses may not be appropriate.

You should be aware of some disciplinary practices to avoid and some guidelines for using punishment.

Even with an effective management system in place, students may lose interest in a lesson and get off task. You must be prepared to respond with appropriate strategies to restore order.

How should you respond to students who are simply off task?

What options do you have when a student misbehaves?

What are some practices to avoid?

What are some guidelines in the use of punishment?

How can chronic misbehavior be addressed?

How can bullying be confronted?

Principle of least intervention

The principle of least intervention states that when dealing with routine classroom behavior, misbehaviors should be corrected with the simplest, least intrusive intervention that will work (Slavin, 2015).

If the least intrusive intervention does not work, then you move up to a more intrusive approach.

The main goal is to handle the misbehavior in an effective manner that avoids unnecessarily disrupting the activity.

To the extent possible, the activity should continue while the misbehavior is handled.

How do you apply this principle of least intervention?

When you notice students starting to lose interest in the lesson or beginning to get off task, you can provide situational assistance

—these are actions to help the student cope with the situation and keep the student on task.

Then if the student is still off task, you can select mild responses to get the student back on task.

If mild responses are not effective, next you can use moderate responses.

Based on the principle of least intervention, this is a three-step response plan.

A Three-Step Response Plan

The teacher must decide when and how to intervene when students are off task or are misbehaving.

An intervention is an action taken by the teacher that is intended to stop the disruptive actions and return the student to the academic activities.

Intervention decisions are typically based on the teacher's knowledge of who is misbehaving, what the misbehavior is, and when it occurs.

Decisions about the type of intervention may depend on the student's history of inappropriate behavior. However, you should not automatically jump to conclusions if an incident involves a student with a history of behavior problems. It is helpful to discuss the problem with the student to clarify the problem from both your perspective and the student's before considering possible interventions.

How do you apply this principle of least intervention?

When you notice students starting to lose interest in the lesson or beginning to get off task, you can provide situational assistance—

Step 1: Provide Situational Assistance

Step 2: Use Mild Responses

Step 3: Use Moderate Responses

Situational Assistance -actions designed to help the students cope with the instructional situation and to keep them on task or to get them back on task before problems worsen.

Situational Assistance Step 1

Students sometimes pause from the instructional task to look out the window, daydream, fidget,, talk with peers, or simply take a brief mental break from the work/play.

In these examples, students are **not** misbehaving—they are simply off task for a short time.

You should take steps to draw students back into the learning activities and keep students on task.

Step 1: Situational Assistance

Purpose: To help the student cope with staying on task

SAMPLE Actions

- Provide support with routines
- Reinforce appropriate behaviors
- Boost interest
- Help over hurdles
- Alter the activity
- Provide calming space

Mild Responses Step 2

Students may misbehave even after you have developed a system of rules and procedures, provided a supportive instructional environment, and given situational assistance to get misbehaving students back on task.

In that case, mild responses should be used to correct the student's behavior.

Mild responses are nonpunitive ways to deal with misbehavior while providing guidance for appropriate behavior.

Nonverbal and verbal mild responses are meant to stop the off-task behavior and to restore order.

Step 2– Use Mild Responses

Purpose: To take non-punishing actions to get student back on task

SAMPLE Actions

Nonverbal Responses

- Ignore behavior
- Use nonverbal signals
- Stand near the child
- Touch the child on hand, arm, or shoulder

Verbal Responses

- Call child's name
- Use humor
- Be Positive
- Remind of rules
- Give choices
- “what should you be doing?”

Moderate Responses Step 3

Following situational assistance and mild nonverbal and verbal responses, students might continue to misbehave.

In that case, moderate responses should be used to correct the problem.

Step 3- Use Moderate Responses

Purpose: To remove desired stimuli to decrease unwanted behavior

SAMPLE Action

Logical Consequences

- Withdraw privileges
- Remove child from group
- Change child's seat
- Have child reflect on behavior
- Ask Office for Assistance
- Contact family
- Have child visit office**
- (**use sparingly ONLY FOR EXTREME BEHAVIORS)

A Three-Step Response Plan

Step 1: Provide Situational Assistance

Step 2: Use Mild Responses

Step 3: Use Moderate Responses

Logical consequences

The hardest part of logical consequences in Step 3 is not setting them up but following through. Never say you're going to do something that is undoable.

Step 3 is the worst-case scenario after you have attempted to curb ongoing behaviors with Steps 1 & 2



Section 6 Reflections

In your own words define positive discipline

Describe the 3-Step Response for managing negative behaviors

Section 8

TEACHER SELF-CARE

TAKING CARE OF YOU!

Mindfulness & Well Being



Stress Management Strategies Every Teacher Needs to Know

Breathe (properly)

The classroom can cause sensory overload. Before you know it, your heart rate starts to climb, you break out into a sweat, and your mind races. In these situations, the most effective first step you can take is to breathe deeply.

Embrace the stress

Turn your ideas on stress upside down. Learn the art of making a negative stressful experience a positive learning opportunity.



Be imperfect

Over the course of a decades-long career in which she has interviewed thousands of people as an academic researcher, Brené Brown **has discovered** that those who are overly stressed and unhappy often share the same trait: they believe that they need to be someone better than who they currently are.

We should always seek to grow ; however, we need to also accept ourselves right where we are! With the idea that we are ever growing, changing, and improving.

Stop comparing yourself to others. Start comparing yourself to where you have been to where you are now! How far have you come, not what someone else is doing.

Ask for help

Yes, it's ok to do this. No matter how long you've been teaching, or how brilliant you are, there will be times when you need help, plain and simple. Asking for help doesn't make you weaker, it makes you better at your job.

Make a connection

According to Kelly McGonigal's research, when you connect with another person, your body produces oxytocin, which is a chemical that helps repair the heart. And you don't even have to be on the receiving end: reaching out to help someone else produces the same effect.



Practice emotional first aid

Do you beat yourself up when you experience failure or make a mistake?

A two-minute distraction is sometimes all that is needed to avoid digging yourself into an emotional rut. Gratefulness can change the course of your headspace.

Be grateful

This isn't about delusion or forcing yourself to be grateful for things that are clearly negative, but rather a determination to see the opportunity present in each moment to move in a new direction.

Being Mindful

Create and practice your own unique mindfulness plan to enhance your life and service to others.

Mindfulness makes you **happier and content**.

Perhaps the most widely publicized benefit of **meditation** is that it makes you **happier**. A Swedish study found that practicing mindfulness was "strongly related" to a positive state of mind and reduced stress.



Mindfulness for Contentment

What do you think of when you think of happiness?

Is it a feeling you chase after but never quite reach, or a state of mind that you're able to tap into if you have the right resources?

Happiness is a state of mind — an underlying sense of contentment, fulfillment, and satisfaction in life.



By taking the time to nurture your mind and becoming more open to the idea of happiness, you are reducing your risk of becoming burdened by anxiety and depression.

**Leading a happier life
reduce stress
get a better night's sleep.**

Just 10 days of using intentional breathing techniques can increase happiness by 16%!

Happy Teachers Make Happy Children!

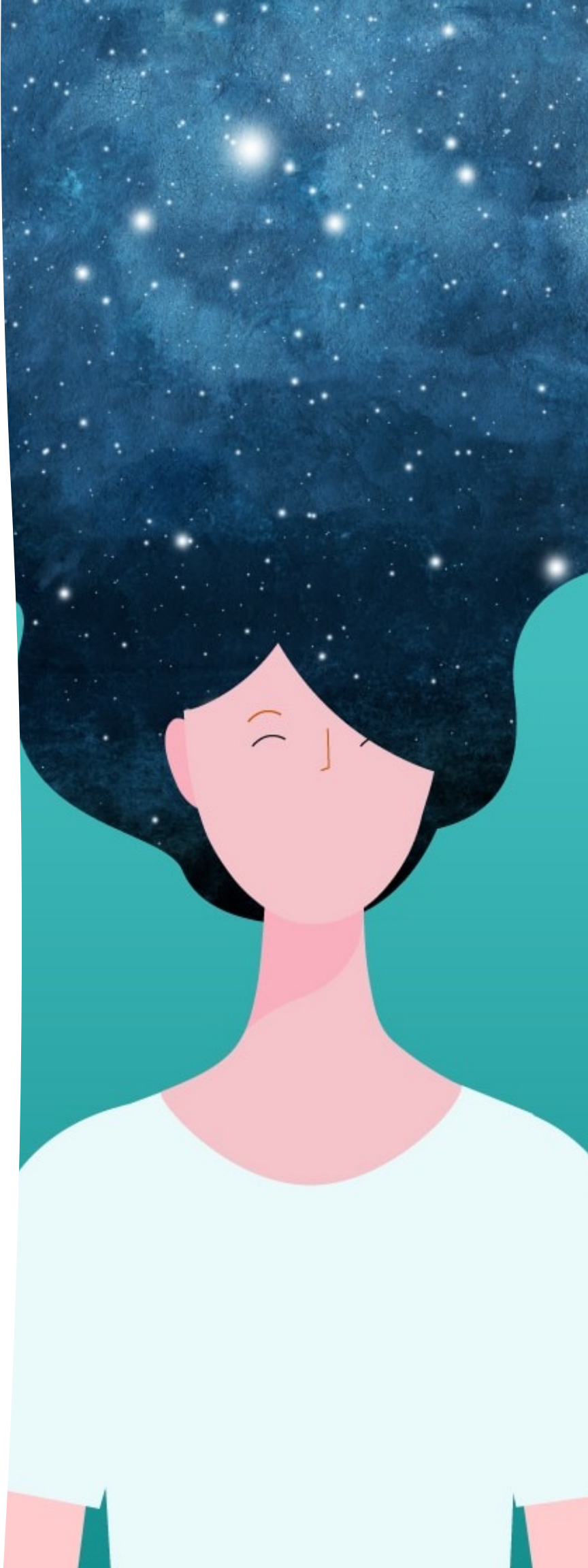


Creating a Positive Mindset

- Being grateful for the things you have can change your life.
- It helps you focus on what's going well so you're less likely to feel depressed about your life.
- Take 1-2 minutes to savor positive moments.
- Additionally, thank people when they do nice things for you.
- Keep a gratitude journal or list 3-5 things you're grateful for each day.
- Your gratitude list might include, "my cat," "a job I love," "a best friend I can call anytime," "a cozy bed," and "good food to eat."
- When you're feeling down, look back over your gratitude list to help you feel better.

Replace negative thoughts with positive self-talk.

Negative thoughts can make it hard to feel happy, but you can change them. When you notice negative thoughts, challenge their accuracy. Then, replace the thought with a positive or neutral thought. Additionally, make positive statements to yourself throughout your day.



Compliment yourself at least once a day. Focus on what you're doing well by giving yourself regular compliments. Celebrate your talents and recognize your accomplishments. This will help you think positively about yourself.

Stop comparing yourself to other people. Everyone is on their own journey, so it's unfair to you to measure your progress by looking at what others have accomplished.

Don't worry about what other people are doing.

Instead, compare yourself to where you were in the past. This will help you see how you're progressing.

Appreciate what others bring to the team.

Success of your class starts with you.
Being a mindful teacher equals
classroom Happiness

1. Mindfulness helps teachers understand our own emotions better

2. Mindfulness helps us communicate more effectively with children

3. Mindfulness helps us manage children we find difficult

4. Mindfulness helps us set up a positive learning environment

Your personal happiness will reflect in your teaching. Your ability to cope with stress and anxiety will affect the children in your classroom.

Take time to take care of yourself. Learn breathing techniques you can do any time anywhere, even in the classroom

Remember Happiness is contagious. So, as a teacher you must be mindful of your own personal headspace.





Mindfulness is a type of meditation in which you focus on being intensely aware of what you're sensing and feeling in the moment, without interpretation or judgment. Practicing mindfulness involves breathing methods, guided imagery, and other practices to relax the body and mind and help reduce stress.

Breathing- focused deep breathing

Gratefulness- state or think about what you are grateful for

Affirmations- I am statements. (I am smart, I am kind, I am...etc.)

The “**STOP**” acronym stands for

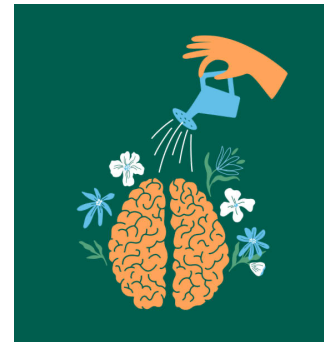
stop, take a breath, observe, and proceed

This four-step technique can take a minute or less. Mindfulness has a number of well-recorded benefits.

What is STOP mindfulness?

The STOP mindfulness technique is a four-step mental checklist that helps you ground yourself in the present moment. The acronym stands for:

- stop
- take a breath
- observe
- proceed



Mindfulness is a practice; you must practice it daily for the full benefits of this stress reducing and life enhancing activity.

Mindfulness is NOT a cure for all life’s problems; however, a regular mindfulness practice will help you be less stressed , happier, and have great focus in time.

It can take days or weeks to create you own mindful practice. If have questions about mindfulness, please ask you Director or Coach for more assistance understand the why and what of this critical component of being a RAP Team member.

12 Ways to Practice Mindfulness



Take a
mindful
brain break



Practice
breathing
techniques



Check in
with your
emotions



www.thepathway2success.com



Use senses
to observe
an object



Take a
mindful
walk



Recite
positive
affirmations

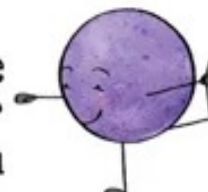
Spend
time
writing in
a journal



Mindfully
listen to
music



Practice
yoga or
stretch



Draw,
color, or
doodle



Read guided
imagery for
relaxation



Spend
extra
time
outside

Principles Of MINDFULNESS

1. No Judgement

Practicing mindfulness makes us aware of our thought processes and when and how we get distracted.

2. Patience is the key

Be patient with our progress and learn from our mistakes.

3. Beginner's mind

The beginner's mind refers to developing a curious mindset to see everything as if it were for the first time. It is a process to see the world with the eyes of a child without any judgment or assumptions.

4. Trust the process

Trust is an essential factor when it comes to learning something new. Mindfulness is a new concept for you; it will take time to excel in it and see the desired results.

5. Non-Striving

Mindfulness is about being satisfied with what you are and how far you've come without thinking of good or bad.

6. Acceptance

Accepting situations as they are and not changing them is the goal of mindfulness. Acceptance helps us learn new things without judging them or changing them.

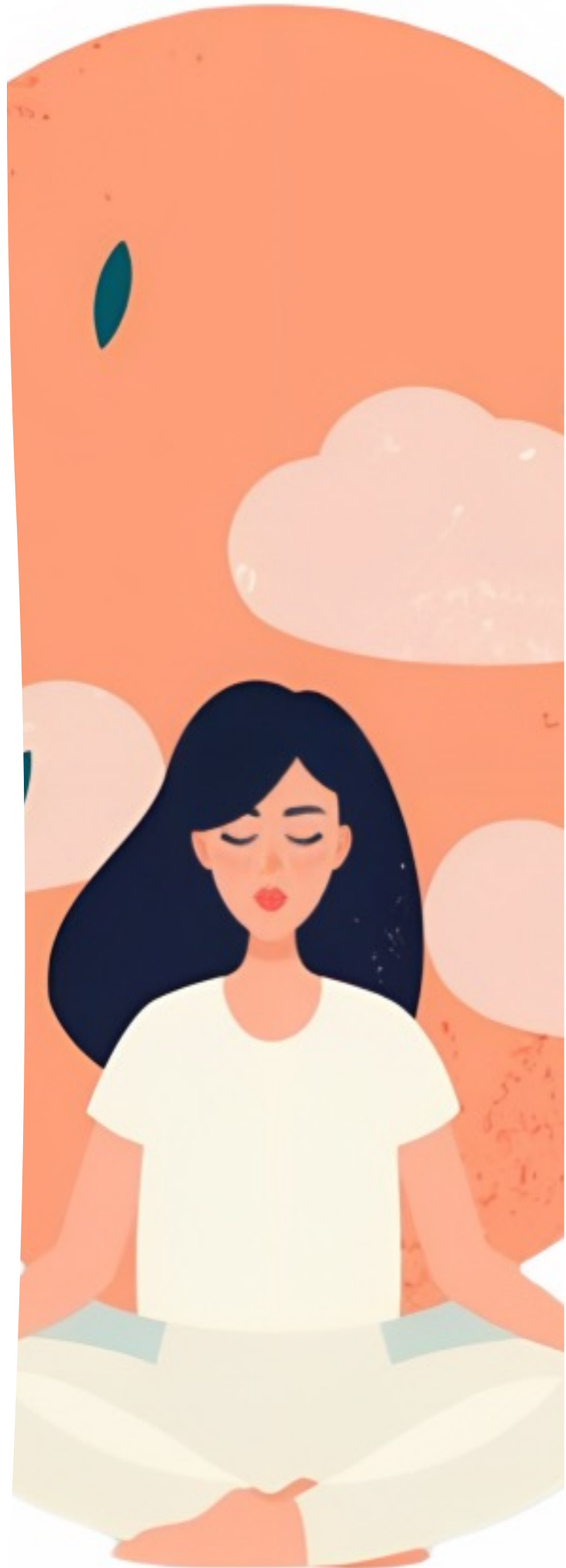
7. Let it go

We cannot control everything or every outcome; the best that one can do in such a situation is to let it go.



Let's Try some Mindfulness

- Sitting comfortably or standing begin to take a deep breath slowly in through your mouth.
- Slowly exhale the breath out the mouth paying attention to your breath, tummy rising, and sounds around you.
- Repeat slowly breathing in out 3 times.
- On the 3rd breathe hold the breath in for 3 seconds then slowly exhale through your mouth.
- Now, that your physical body is a calmer state, begin to think about and state out loud to yourself what you are grateful for. State 3 things you are grateful in this present moment.
- Next, is Affirmations; these are I am statement. State out loud 3 I am statements.
- Close your mindfulness with 3 deep breathies in , holding the 3rd and releasing slowly.



Section 7 Reflections

In your own words define mindfulness and why RAP Places so much importance on this?

Reflect on your thoughts about mindfulness ; concerns, likes, dislikes or questions.

Section 9

Mindfulness in the Classroom



How

Create your own practice- You would have trouble teaching how to share or communicate with peers if you had never done this yourself. Mindfulness is the same, you need to have your own personal practice, so you can model and share with the children in your class.

Keep it Simple- mindfulness activities for children should be simple , easy, and direct.

Check your Expectations- are you expecting mindfulness to stop all classroom behaviors? Maybe you hope it will be a cure all for your life and classroom? While mindfulness is beneficial for stress, focus, and relaxation it is not magical remedy for all your classroom behaviors or personal needs. If you have unreasonable expectation, you will be likely to be disappointed.

Don't Force it- Please never force it. If the children are not interested at all , and you cannot get them on task, stop, and try again another time. Make the time brief and the activity engaging.

Remember- it takes practice, both personally and for your class. Don't give up.





What does it look like in the Mindful Morning Circle Time?

Expectations

- Ones- 1 – 2 Minute
- Twos 2- 5 Minutes
- Threes 3-5 minutes
- Fours 5– 8 minutes
- PreK 5- 8 minutes
- School Age- 5-10 minutes

(Go longer if you can , but do NOT ever force the mindfulness activities. If they are not interested move on and try again later.)

How?

Breathing -----Gratitude-----Affirmations

*Gratitude is what you are thankful for

*Affirmations are I am statements I am wanted, I am beautiful, I am kind...

6 Mindfulness Activities

for teachers & students

1. Slow deep breathing exercises

Breathe in to the count of 4-6. Hold for the count of 4-6. Exhale for 4-6. Repeat.

2. Stop and stretch your body

Stop and regularly stretch throughout the day to help alleviate stiffness & get blood flowing

3. Move your body to some music

Use catchy music to do a quick tidy; slow, quiet music for relaxation

4. Have a brain break

Use a brain break at regular intervals e.g. hop on one foot, jumping jacks, toe touches or rub your head & pat your tummy

5. Do a body scan

Stand tall and concentrate your thoughts to each part of your body as you slowly work your way from your feet to your head

6. Switch off all devices

Give yourself a mental rest and be present in the moment by switching off all technology

Belly breathing

Ask your child to lie on the floor
and pop a teddy on their tummy.

See if they can take a big breath
that fills their tummy with air.

Can they see teddy getting higher and higher?

Now, can they breathe out and watch him fall?

Try this a few times to help
your child feel relaxed.

PS. It works on grown-ups, too!



five things

Mindfulness Activity

5 things you can see



4 things you can feel



3 things you can hear



2 things you can smell



1 thing you can taste



Developmental Mindfulness

Infants - Soothing songs, lights and shadows, a calm environment. These all build on future mindfulness skills for the child.

Toddlers– This age group needs props to help achieve an understanding of the mindfulness process. Breathing balls, glitter bottles, rain sticks, light/shadow etc.

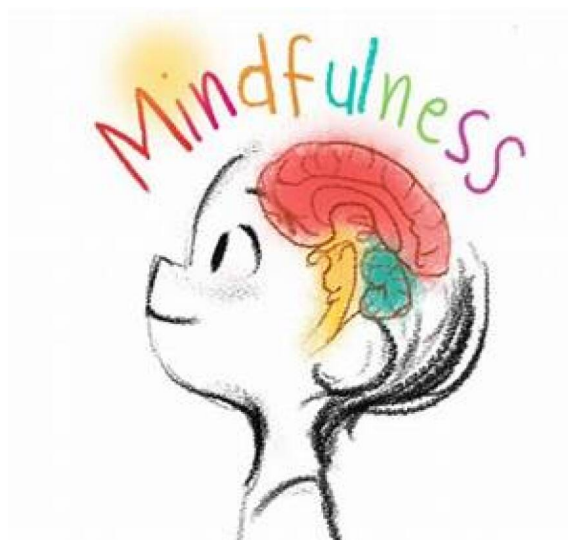
Preschool and up - This age groups is able to engage in mindfulness with an adult leading them as a group. This group should begin to be able to practice mindfulness on their own during day at times they need self-soothing or emotional support.

MINDFULNESS IS NOT JUST FOR THE MORNING!

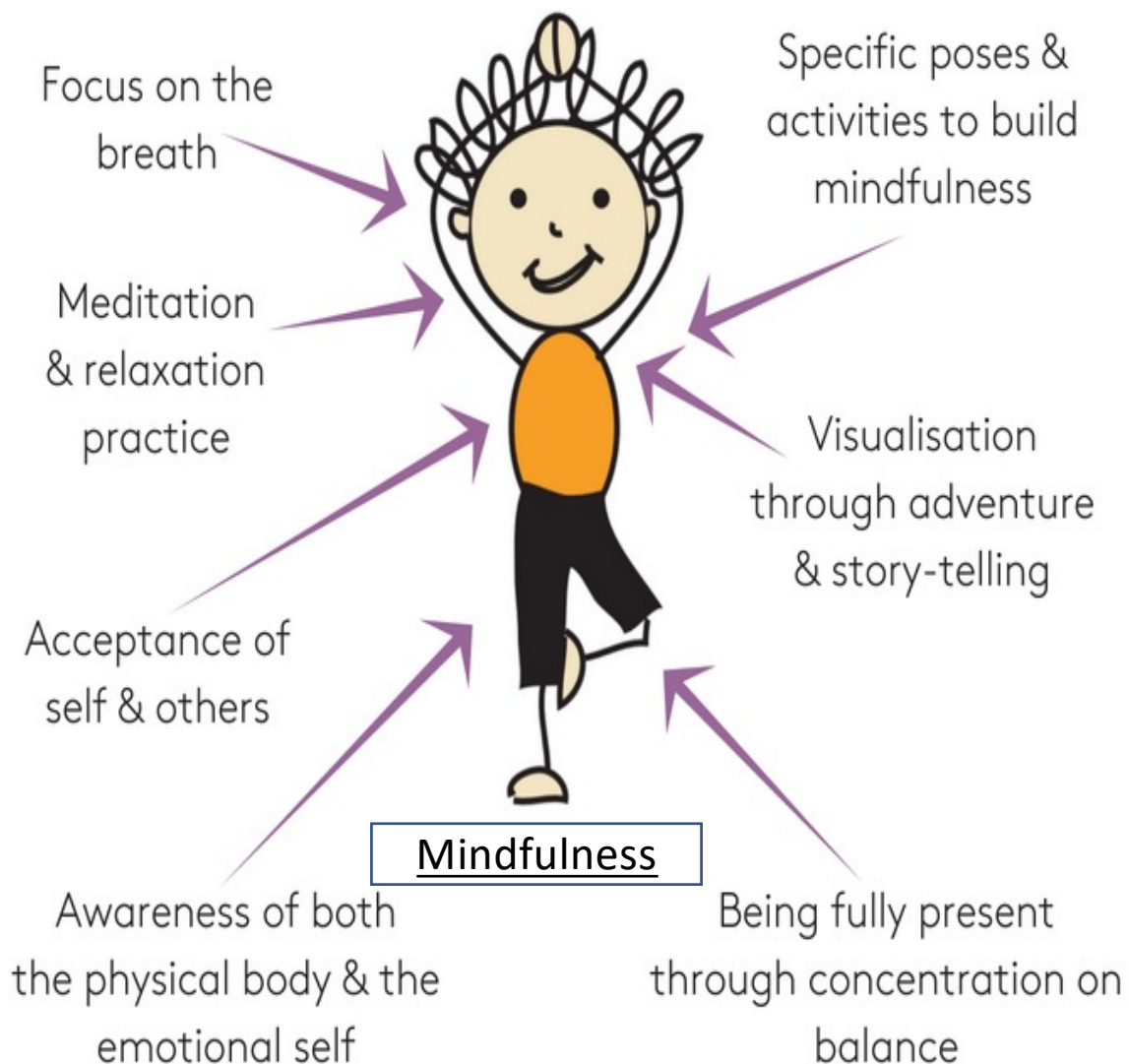
Although each classroom should have a planned whole group Mindful Morning i the A.M, mindfulness is for anytime of day, for single children, and small groups.

The goal of Mindful Morning is to set –the stage for learning and to teach children how to be mindful independently.

Mindfulness can hep children focus, calm, engage, be happy, manages behaviors and is soothing. Use mindfulness anytime a child needs emotional support.



How yoga promotes mindfulness for children



Mindfulness is and IMPORTANT PART OF YOUR DAY!

Each day you should be practicing age-appropriate mindfulness with your children.

This is not an option but a required part of our curriculum.

If you need help with ideas, please ask.



Section 9 Reflections

Thinking of the age group you primarily work with give 2 examples of a mindful activity that would be age-appropriate and give examples.

Reflect on your thoughts about Mindfulness in the classroom, likes, dislikes or questions.

Section 10

80

Your Thoughts and 10 clock hours

If you have completed all the Reflection questions and read over each section in this book, please make a Director aware so they can review your work and answer any questions you may have.

To complete this training and earn 10 clock hours in the registry you must complete the Personal Mindfulness Plan on the next page and reflect on it with a Director.

Please fill out and return this page via email or in person to
Michele
michele@raisingarizonapreschool.com

Name _____ Location _____

Registry Number _____

Director Initials _____

Remove from book and scan to email if needed. Or take photo.

My Personal Mindfulness Plan

Write a 1 -3 paragraphs about your understanding, feelings, and questions you may have about a personal mindfulness practice.

Include your plan for your own mindfulness. How will you begin to incorporate mindfulness into your daily life?

Notes